Lena Cho

Housing reporter, Milwaukee. I report on who gets to stay.

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Experience

2023 – present
Housing reporter, Lakeshore Ledger
Eviction court, landlords, code enforcement and city hall for a nonprofit newsroom. 140 stories; two led to city ordinances.

2025
Contributing reporter, Cream City Public Radio
“Waiting for Section 8”, a three-part audio series.

2022
Metro intern, Lakeshore Ledger
Courts and public-safety briefs; first records requests.

Selected stories

Mar 2026
One courtroom, 40 evictions a morning
61 mornings in eviction court. Followed by a right-to-counsel pilot for 1,200 families.

Oct 2025
The landlord with 412 addresses and no phone number
Property records and 2,300 code complaints traced to one network of LLCs.

Jun 2025
Waiting for Section 8
Three families, one waitlist that opened for 72 hours.

Education

2019 – 2023
BA Journalism, Marquette University
Minor in Spanish. Editor, the student paper’s city desk.

Skills

Reporting
Public records requests, court and property records, interviewing in Spanish

Tools
Spreadsheets, basic SQL, Datawrapper, audio recording and editing